STAT 1210: Assignment 3

Part III: Foundations of Inference

Fall 2026 Semester

Instructions

- Your work should show all steps clearly for each question.
- Your solutions must be handwritten on lined or letter-sized paper. Your name and student number must appear on the first page.
- Your name should also appear on every additional page, and all pages should be stapled together.
- R may be used to check numerical results, but the requested calculations, standardizations and statistical reasoning must be shown.
- Report numerical answers to at least three decimal places when appropriate.
- Programming resources, textbooks and software manuals may be consulted, but all submitted work must be your own. Solutions generated by generative AI tools are not permitted.

Question 1

A veterinary epidemiology team wants to study whether regular physical activity is associated with obesity among adult dogs in Prince Edward Island. Five veterinary clinics volunteered to participate. During a two-week period, owners arriving for appointments were invited to complete a questionnaire about their dog's average daily activity. A veterinarian then classified each participating dog as obese or not obese. The results for the 600 participating dogs are shown below.

Average daily activity	**Obese**	**Not obese**	**Total**
At least 60 minutes	18	132	150
Less than 60 minutes	126	324	450
Total	144	456	600

1. Calculate the proportion of obese dogs separately for the two activity groups. Describe the association between daily activity and obesity in the sample.

2. Classify the study as observational or experimental, and state whether random sampling or random assignment was used. Identify one plausible confounding variable and one potential source of selection bias. Use these features of the study design to explain why the results cannot establish causation or be confidently generalized to all adult dogs in Prince Edward Island.

Question 2

A fisheries agency estimates that the probability that a tagged juvenile Atlantic salmon survives a particular downstream migration route is $p = 0.42$. Suppose a random sample of $n = 400$ tagged salmon is followed under similar environmental conditions. Let $\hat{p}$ be the proportion of salmon in the sample that survive the route. Assume that the survival outcomes can be treated as independent and that the population is sufficiently large relative to the sample.

1. Identify the population parameter and the sample statistic. Then calculate the mean and standard deviation of the sampling distribution of $\hat{p}$ using

$$\mu_{\hat{p}} = p \qquad \text{and} \qquad \sigma_{\hat{p}} = \sqrt{\frac{p(1-p)}{n}}$$

   Interpret both quantities in context.

2. Verify the expected-count conditions required for an approximately Normal sampling distribution of $\hat{p}$. Then state the approximate sampling distribution, including its shape, centre and spread.

3. Use the Normal approximation to calculate

$$P(\hat{p} \leq 0.38)$$

   Show the standardization calculation before using the Standard Normal table.

4. Use the Normal approximation to calculate

$$P(0.40 \leq \hat{p} \leq 0.46)$$

   Show both standardized boundary values.

Question 3

A veterinary hospital network wants to estimate the population mean recovery time following a routine anaesthetic procedure for adult dogs. The network performed this procedure on more than 1000 adult dogs during the study period. A simple random sample of 64 dogs has a sample mean recovery time of 47.8 minutes. Based on long-term monitoring of the same procedure, the population standard deviation is treated as known at $\sigma = 12$ minutes.

1. Define the population parameter μ in the context of this study. What statistic is being used as its point estimate?

2. Assess the random-sampling, independence, 10% and Normal-sampling-distribution conditions for using a one-sample z confidence interval. State any assumption that cannot be checked directly from the information provided.

3. Construct a 95% confidence interval for the population mean recovery time. Show the standard error, critical value, margin of error and interval endpoints. Interpret the interval in the context of the hospital network, referring to the population mean rather than to individual recovery times.

4. Construct a 99% confidence interval using $z^* = 2.576$. Compare its width with the width of the 95% interval and explain why the widths differ.

Question 4

Under an established sedation protocol, the population mean resting respiratory rate of adult harbour seals during recovery is reported to be 18 breaths per minute. A marine veterinary team introduces a revised protocol. Because respiratory rates that are either too low or too high may be clinically important, the team wants to determine whether the population mean under the revised protocol differs from 18 breaths per minute. One respiratory-rate measurement is obtained from each of 25 randomly selected adult harbour seals treated under the revised protocol.

18	22	19	23	17
21	20	23	16	23
19	18	22	21	20
24	15	23	19	20
23	18	21	17	21

Long-term monitoring indicates that respiratory rates under comparable conditions are approximately Normal with population standard deviation $\sigma = 4$ breaths per minute. Use a significance level of $\alpha = 0.05$.

1. Define the population parameter μ. State the null and alternative hypotheses, and explain why the alternative hypothesis is two-sided.

2. Calculate the sample mean, the standard error and the one-sample z test statistic. Interpret the sign and magnitude of the test statistic in context.

3. Calculate the two-sided P-value using a Standard Normal table. Show how the probability in one tail is converted into a two-sided probability. Compare the P-value with $\alpha = 0.05$, state the decision about H_0 and write a conclusion in context.

4. Describe a Type I error and a Type II error in the context of this study. Which error might be more serious from an animal-safety perspective? Explain your reasoning.

5. Construct a 95% confidence interval for the population mean respiratory rate. Determine whether 18 lies inside the interval and explain how this agrees with the test decision. Does statistical significance alone establish clinical importance? Explain briefly.

Question 5

A veterinary diagnostic laboratory is evaluating a portable blood-glucose meter for use with canine blood samples. For each sample, the laboratory calculates

$$\text{difference} = \text{portable-meter reading} - \text{reference-laboratory reading}$$

A positive difference means that the portable meter tends to read higher than the reference method. A simple random sample of 400 stored canine blood samples gives a mean difference of $\bar{x} = 0.30$ mg/dL. Based on previous validation work, the population standard deviation of the differences is treated as known at $\sigma = 2.4$ mg/dL. The laboratory tests

$$H_0 : \mu = 0 \qquad \text{against} \qquad H_a : \mu \neq 0$$

at the significance level $\alpha = 0.05$. For operational purposes, the laboratory considers a population mean bias with magnitude less than 1.0 mg/dL to be too small to be practically important.

1. Define the population parameter μ in context. Calculate the standard error, the one-sample z statistic and the two-sided P-value. State the decision about H_0 at $\alpha = 0.05$.

2. Construct a 95% confidence interval for μ. Explain how the interval leads to the same decision as the two-sided test in Part 1.

3. Distinguish between statistical significance and practical importance for this study. Use the confidence interval and the laboratory's 1.0 mg/dL threshold in your explanation. Identify one possible source of systematic error or bias that is not included in the interval's margin of error.

4. Construct a 99% confidence interval using $z^* = 2.576$. Compare it with the 95% interval and explain why the corresponding test decision at $\alpha = 0.01$ differs from the decision at $\alpha = 0.05$.

5. For a future study, suppose the laboratory is concerned only with positive bias and plans to test $H_0 : \mu = 0$ against $H_a : \mu > 0$. The laboratory wants 90% power to detect a true mean bias of $\delta = 0.6$ mg/dL using $\alpha = 0.05$ and $\sigma = 2.4$ mg/dL. Calculate the required sample size using

$$n = \left(\frac{(z_{1-\alpha} + z_{\text{power}})\sigma}{\delta} \right)^2$$

with $z_{1-\alpha} = 1.645$ and $z_{\text{power}} = 1.282$. Explain why the result must be rounded up.

Bonus Questions

Bonus Question 1 [+2 marks]

A viral video claims that wrapping a room-temperature beer can in a wet paper towel and placing it in a freezer will cool the beer to a suitable serving temperature in less than 15 minutes. The video confidently promises that the beer will be cold "before you finish choosing what to watch," but does not report the freezer temperature. A researcher tests the method using 64 cans that begin at the same temperature. The mean time required to reach the target temperature is $\bar{x} = 14.2$ minutes. Assume that the population standard deviation is known to be $\sigma = 2.4$ minutes. The researcher tests

$$H_0 : \mu = 15 \qquad \text{against} \qquad H_a : \mu < 15$$

using $\alpha = 0.05$. A reduction of less than 2 minutes is considered too small to be practically important.

a. **[1 mark]** Calculate the standard error, the z test statistic and the one-sided P-value. State the decision about H_0. Then construct a 95% confidence interval for μ using $z^* = 1.960$.

b. **[1 mark]** Is the result statistically significant, practically important, both or neither? Explain one limitation of using cans from a single brand and testing them in a single freezer. Would testing more cans under the same conditions eliminate this limitation? Explain.

Bonus Question 2 [+3 marks]

Choose a real-life or realistic study in which a survey produced a potentially biased conclusion because of the way participants were selected, the way the survey questions were written, or both. In a response of at least **seven complete sentences**, explain the study and evaluate its design. Your response could include:

- Describe the research question and the population the researchers wanted to study.
- Explain how the survey participants were selected.
- Identify at least one source of selection bias, such as undercoverage, voluntary-response bias or nonresponse bias.
- Identify at least one problem involving question wording, question order or response options, such as a leading, loaded, vague or double-barrelled question.
- Explain the likely direction of the bias and how it could affect the reported conclusion.
- Propose a more appropriate sampling method.
- Rewrite or otherwise improve the problematic survey question or questions.

Your response will be graded on the accuracy of the statistical reasoning, the clarity of the real-world explanation and the quality of the proposed improvements.